



5 Add more compost around the sides of the plant, gently tapping this into position with a dibber, chopstick, or pencil. Make sure you are happy that there is enough soil for roots to grow before going on to the next step.



6 Fill in around the plants with moss using tweezers. You can also add items from nature, such as twigs, driftwood, stones, pebbles, or shells to create a mini landscape scene in the terrarium.



7 Remove soil from the sides of the glass with a mister. Water then seal and leave the terrarium to create its own atmosphere. If the glass mists up inside, it is working!

CARE ADVICE

WHERE TO SITE

You must place your terrarium out of direct sunlight, so don't choose a sunny windowsill. They need low light, but enough to be able to grow without becoming straggly.

WATERING

The key to a terrarium is that it is self-sufficient. Plants form condensation in the enclosed environment, water drips down the sides and they water themselves. If the condensation stops or the soil looks dry, water

plants by using a meat baster or misting the inside. Don't overwater, especially in winter. Tropical or carnivorous plants need a bit more water, preferring rainwater, and while they do not enjoy being soggy they must always be wet, so maintain the water level at 5cm (2in) below the surface of the soil. Add more sand to the planting medium for these plants, too.

GENERAL CARE

Air the terrarium every 2–3 weeks for a few hours, especially in the spring and summer.

If you've chosen the right plants and the right container size to match, the terrarium will keep going for a while, without needing replacement plants. You can keep plants in shape by pruning; make sure you remove any trimmed foliage and any plant that begins to rot. Plants rot because of too much moisture, so you will need to redress the balance by opening the lid more frequently. The soil can be refreshed after a while by scraping off the surface layer and replacing it with fresh compost.

